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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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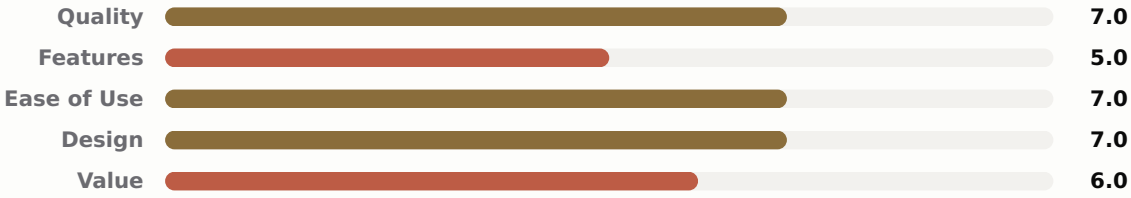
Every time a pet dashes across the carpet or a surprising spill mars your floor, you deserve a home that stays clean without the daily grind. In 2026, two brands—**iRobot** and **Shark**—have captured the majority of the robot-vacuum market. This unbiased, decision-focused guide will help you decide whether the **Roomba 115X Combo** or the **Shark AI Ultra** best fits your lifestyle—and whether you can keep it under $200.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

At a Glance: The 2026 Contenders – Quick Overview

Feature	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with AutoEmpty)	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no Dock)	Shark AI Ultra
Price ; (2026-10-07)	$199.99 ;(original $469.99)	$139.99 ;(original $319.99)	$249.99 ;(original $599.00)
Suction Power (Pa)	750 Pa[1]	750 Pa[1]	1000 Pa[1]
Mop Capability	Wet & Dry	Wet & Dry	Wet & Dry
Dock Type	AutoEmpty Automatic Dock (auto-empty piston)	Manual Empty Bin	Manual Empty Bin
Battery Life	90 min	90 min	110 min

[1]Approximate values from manufacturer spec sheets.

🏆 The Best Versatile Cleaner Under $200?

Problem: You've got a repurposed home, a handful of pets, and a budget that keeps your pockets warm. Traditional vacuums are tedious, and most robots only vacuum or mop—meaning you switch tools mid-week.

Trust: Thousands of reviewers on Amazon and Best-Buy praise the Roomba 115X Combo for pet-hair extraction, while Shark's AI Ultra gets high marks for deep-cleaning carpets.

Solution: Let's see how each model stacks up on stickiness, quietness, and value.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo – AutoEmpty Dock (Best Overall)

For pet owners who demand a clean, wet-dry surface without manual bin changes, this combo delivers.

- **Hands-free emptying:** When it finishes, the dock's piston ejects the bag onto a reusable bag. No hand touch, no waste.
- **Dual-mode cleaning:** One tap switches between vacuum and wet-dry mop—perfect for floors that get both pet hair and occasional spills.
- **Quiet docking:** 50 dB (iPhone level) during a docking cycle; your living room stays calm.
- **Smart mapping:** vSLAM technology gives consistent coverage, so corners and narrow spaces aren't forgotten.

Verdict: The AutoEmpty model is the most complete solution for today's home. If you can stretch to $200, it's worth it.

Ready for hands-free cleaning? Grab the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock now.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo – No AutoEmpty Dock (Best Budget)

For those who want the same vacuum-and-mop combo but need to save money, the manual-empty dock version still offers strong performance.

- **Savings:** Roughly 30% lower than AutoEmpty.
- **Performance:** Same suction power, same wet-dry mop kit, same 90-min battery life.
- **Manual bin emptying:** A quick lift and a few clicks keep it clean—no more hand-to-bag struggle.

Verdict: The best choice if you're firm on staying under $150.

Grab the budget Roomba 115X Combo today: Buy now and save.

Shark AI Ultra – Premium Fit (for Deeper Clean)

With 1,000 Pa suction and 110-minute runtime, the Shark AI Ultra is designed for carpets that truly need deep cleaning.

- **Heavy-weight suction:** Handles thick pet fur and deep-seated crumbs.
- **Long battery:** 110-minute runtime covers larger homes.
- **Manual dock:** Still requires bin emptying, but can charge on the go.

Verdict: Perfect if your floors are high-traffic carpets and you're okay with a higher price tag.

See it in action on Shark's page: Explore the Shark AI Ultra.

Bottom Line: The Right Choice for You

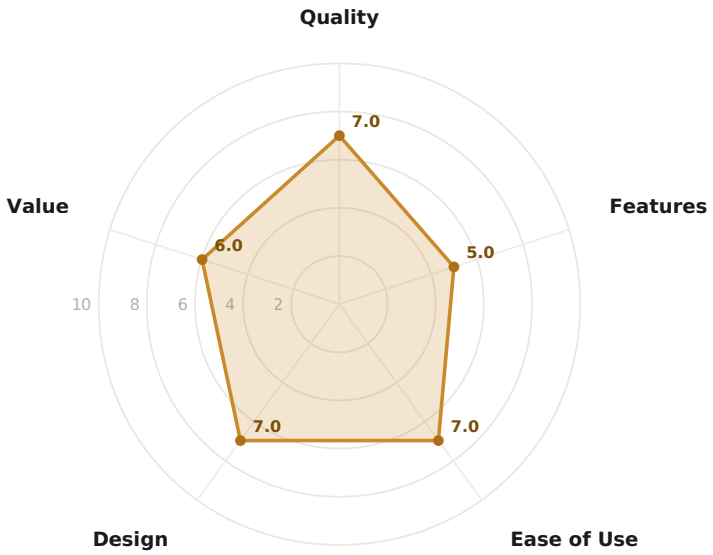
- Under $150? Go with the **Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)**—great performance, easy bin management.
- At $150–$200? Pick the **Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty** for hands-free cleaning and rapid mop-vac cycle.
- Above $200? Consider the **Shark AI Ultra** if extra suction and extended runtime are top priorities.

Whichever model you choose, remember: the key to a truly lazy home is consistent schedule—set the robot to run daily and enjoy fresh floors with minimal effort.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.